

Sharad Pawar

Minister for agriculture, consumer affairs, food and public distribution

Days as minister: 1,287

NUMBER OF TRIPS: 27

Official: 7 For BCCI: 17

Personal: 3

DAYS ABROAD: 97

Official: 37 For BCCI: 49

Personal: 11

Km travelled: 2,62,597

Official: 86,133 km

For BCCI: 1,36,917 km

Personal: 39,547 km

OFFICIAL EXPENSES:

Rs 1.03 crore

Pawar has travelled abroad more often as Indian cricket board chief than representing his ministry of agriculture.



Soni has spent 23 days abroad on personal trips—which include Italy, the birth place of Sonia Gandhi, as a destination—of which itineraries for 11 days were not disclosed by PMO.

Ambika Soni, minister for tourism and culture



Securing access to so much information would have been impossible—considering the thickness of red tapes—had there not been the RTI Act in place. When INDIA TODAY filed an RTI application in PMO on September 27 last year requesting the details of foreign visits of ministers since the UPA Government was formed, along with the approximate expenditure incurred by each of them, the PMO provided all the details except that bit on the expenditure incurred. The response said, “The culled information does not include expenditure involved in each trip which this

office does not maintain and may be obtained from individual ministries/departments.” Subsequently, the magazine got in touch with every ministry and requested the details of foreign visits made by cabinet ministers and ministers of state along with the names of delegates and the approximate expenditure by them for each trip. Sibal’s Ministry of Science and Technology came up with the expenditure incurred on the cash allowances of the minister and other officials on foreign trips but not the airfare. For airfare alone, a request was for-